The Initiative would become effective on the first day of the calendar quarter commencing more than 110 days after voter approval and would cease after twenty (20) years unless subsequently extended by voter approval.

ARGUMENT IN FAVOR OF MEASURE S

VOTE YES on Measure S to improve PUBLIC SAFETY across Imperial County.

When life-threatening emergencies strike, **EVERY SECOND COUNTS.** Since 1907, your Imperial County firefighters and sheriff's deputies have answered the call, heroically saving lives, eliminating threats, reducing crime, and protecting families, homes, and property across Imperial County's massive 4,500 square mile area.

Here's the problem: limited funding and rising costs have taken their toll, leaving County public safety professionals spread dangerously thin. Today, our Imperial County first responders serve **without** modern technology, working with deteriorated fire stations, aging equipment, and an obsolete Emergency Operations Center (EOC). They use an outdated 911 dispatch system and Coroner's Office so limited **that ALL autopsies** must be sent to San Diego County for processing. Protecting the public's safety under these conditions is itself, tragic.

Measure S provides a responsible solution.

Passage of Measure S will:

- Improve 911 emergency response across Imperial County.
- Modernize technology, allowing law enforcement, firefighters and paramedics to communicate with each other **at ALL times**.
- Upgrade deteriorated fire stations, public safety facilities and lifesaving vehicles/equipment.
- Retain/attract qualified first responders.
- Improve 911 response during natural disasters and major safety threats.

To fund these dire needs, Measure S authorizes a modest, locally controlled ½-cent sales tax, countywide, expiring in 20 years.

Taxpayer Protections are REQUIRED! By law, ALL Measure S funds go strictly to Imperial County PUBLIC SAFETY. The State CAN'T take this funding away. The County CAN'T use it for other purposes. Independent Citizens' Oversight, mandatory audits and public disclosure ensure proper spending.

Firefighters, paramedics, County Sheriff Fred Miramontes, deputy sheriffs, safety advocates, community leaders, and concerned residents across Imperial County urge your support.

REMEMBER: Your VOTE is an investment in YOUR future. Give first responders the tools they need to protect us when we need them most.

For a safer, stronger Imperial County, **VOTE YES on S.**

www.saferimperialcounty.com

SIGNATORIES
Fred Miramontes, Imperial Co. Sheriff, 50+ yrs. in Public Safety, Lifelong Imperial Co. Resident, Youth Advocate
Martha Cardenas-Singh, Imperial Co. Supervisor, District 2 & Former El Centro Mayor and City Council Member
Mark McBroom, Lifelong IC Resident, Citrus Grower/Businessman, Philanthropist, & Brawley HS Graduate
Norma Aguilar, Calexico Homeowner, Parent, Public Safety Advocate, 20-yr. SDSU/Calexico Disabled Students Advocate
David Lantzer, Imperial Co. Fire Chief, 39-year Firefighter, 30-year IC Resident & Holtville Homeowner

COUNTY COUNSEL'S IMPARTIAL ANALYSIS OF IMPERIAL COUNTY PUBLIC SAFETY SALES AND USE TAX INITIATIVE

The Imperial County Public Safety Sales and Use Tax Initiative ("Measure") is an initiative that was placed on the ballot by a petition signed by the requisite number of voters. The Measure proposes the adoption of a sales tax upon all retailers of tangible personal property in the incorporated and unincorporated Imperial County at a rate of 0.5 cent and a use tax imposed on storage, use or other consumption of tangible personal property in Imperial County at a rate of 0.5 cent, with limited exemptions and exceptions. The taxes would be administered by the California Department of Tax and Fee Administration.

Approval of the Measure would increase the applicable sales and use tax each by 0.5 cent for a period of 20 years. The Measure provides that the revenue generated by the tax shall be deposited into a Public Safety Fund. According to the Measure, funds in the Public Safety Fund may only be used for the construction, improvement, and maintenance of public safety facilities, such as fire stations, law enforcement facilities, and a Coroner's Facility, in El Centro, Brawley Salton City, Ocotillo, and Calexico; the purchase of fire safety vehicles, equipment and supplies; and the funding of ongoing operational maintenance and repair costs for County-owned public safety and emergency facilities and fleet services, as well as administrative costs associated with implementing the Measure. The Measure also establishes a 7-member Citizen's Oversight Committee to meet publicly semi-annually to review all revenues and expenditures of the funds collected from the taxes, review annual audit reports, and make at least one annual report to the Board of Supervisors at a public meeting summarizing the Oversight Committee's